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Software Engineer

Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 26th July 2026



Driver & Vehicle
Licensing
Agency

Reference number

468088

Salary

£39,163

The salary of £39,163 (basic salary £35, 663) includes a non-pensionable Recruitment & Retention Allowance of £3,500

Job grade

Higher Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

DVLA - Information Technology Services

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

6

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Location

Swansea

About the job

Job summary

Are you an experienced Software Engineer who has a genuine ambition and aim to succeed?

Would you like to work with leading serverless, and cloud based technologies?

If so, we'd love to hear from you!

We are recruiting software developers, to work with us and help us build services that reach over 53 million people a year. In this role, you'll work in an agile delivery team alongside lead and senior engineers to build modern, cloud-based services.

Joining our department comes with many benefits, including:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [here](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Read more in the Benefits section below!

Find out more about what it's like working at [Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency - Department for Transport Careers.](#)

Job description

The Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency (DVLA) deliver wide reaching digital services to the UK public and industry. We maintain the national record of vehicles and drivers so if you have applied for a driving licence, taxed your vehicle or completed a vehicle enquiry you would have used one of our services.

Within and between our teams, we have a friendly and stable engineering community. Keeping work/life enjoyable is key to us, and we strive to ensure the efficient and secure use of software and infrastructure.

Our current deliveries include:

- Two major programmes of work, modernising our drivers and vehicles services and systems.

- Entirely new services including a new customer portal, mobile digital driving licence and identity platform.

- The DVLA digital payment service that helps us collect around 6 billion pounds a year.

New versions of key driving licence services that will help us to reduce paper forms, reduce waiting times and to enable all of our customers to transact digitally.

If you are successful, you will be part of the new electronic Vehicle Excise Duty programme which is a new legislative, digital service being delivered by DVLA to modernise how Vehicle Excise Duty is administered and delivered digitally. This is an exciting time to join us!

As part of our core business services, you will work with Java and SpringBoot alongside tools like OpenAPI. No specific Java experience is needed. All you need is a passion for building clean, maintainable, and secure applications using an object-oriented language.

If you're working on the front-end, you'll be developing applications and reusable components using a combination of Ruby on Rails and React. You will also have the opportunity to build and develop our external and internal

UIs, so this is an exciting opportunity to deliver far reaching, intuitive and accessible front-end systems.

We also make extensive use of serverless Node.js and TypeScript using AWS services such as Lambda, Step Functions and Dynamodb to build services using event-driven architecture patterns.

DVLA have been using AI coding assistants for over two years and actively encourage and support the appropriate use of AI coding tools. We have an AI coding group and are working together to understand how to use AI coding assistants responsibly to build better digital services.

As part of our ongoing mission to support and develop all staff within the DVLA, you will be given a high spec Macbook and we will help you to achieve certification in areas such as AWS and Java, as well as giving you the freedom and support necessary to perform in your role and continuously develop your skill set.

Your responsibilities will include, but aren't limited to:

- Developing Software to meet user needs.

- Following Best Practice Guidelines and help to improve those Guidelines.

- Writing clean, secure and well-tested code.

- Coaching and mentoring more junior colleagues.

- Operating the services they build and identify issues in production.

Great line management is important to us as an organisation, and we will equip and support line managers to develop the skills they need. We aim to empower line managers to create teams where people can flourish and deliver excellent outcomes for the public.

For further information on the role, please read the attached role profile. Please note that the role profile is for information purposes only - whilst all elements are relevant to the role, they may not all be assessed during the recruitment process. This job advert will detail exactly what will be assessed during the recruitment process.

Would you like to find out more about the role, the team and what it's like to work in our department? If so, we are organising an open session where you can virtually 'meet the team' on 22nd July 2026 at 12:00pm. Sign up [here](#).

Person specification

Required experience:

You will be experienced working as a software engineer across multiple projects, developing software using a variety of technologies and tools.

You will be able to work with a team to shape and define requirements and have the skills to build, test, and deliver features and services.

You will need an awareness of CI/CD tooling with an understanding of languages such as Java, Ruby, C#, HTML, Python or similar.

You may have experience delivering services using a public cloud provider such as AWS, Azure or Google Cloud, or a motivation to develop these skills.

Additional Information

Working for the DVLA Digital Team

At DVLA, licensing is just the start. Every project you implement, touch and deliver has a ripple effect that'll wash across the nation. Here the work you're doing has the capacity to change the way 53 million people interact with our services. As we aim to keep our roads some of the safest in the world, our innovative, transformative digital-led services help optimise a nation of individuals and business every single day.

To see how our people are transforming our digital services, head over to our [DVLA Digital Services Blog](#) and, to understand more about the great opportunities and benefits of working at DVLA read our [Inside DVLA blog](#).

Our Principal Engineer covers some hot topics across our Software Development areas which you can find here, ["DVLA Software Developer: Behind the Screens"](#). To read about the DVLA's engineering site please [click here](#).

Working hours, office attendance and travel requirements

Full time roles consist of 37 hours per week.

This role **is suitable** for hybrid working, which is a non-contractual arrangement where a combination of workplace and home-based working can be accommodated subject to business requirements.

The expectation at present is a minimum of **60%** of your working time a month will be spent at either your designated workplace (one of the locations cited in the advert) or, when required for business reasons, in another office/ work location. There may be occasions where you are required to attend above the minimum expectation.

If you have a question about hybrid working, part time/job share hours, flexible working, travelling for work, or require a reasonable adjustment, please contact the Vacancy Holder during the recruitment process to avoid possible disappointment later in the process should your working arrangements not be compatible with the requirements of the role (see below for contact details).

Sponsorship

Please note that we do not hold a UK Visa & Immigration (UKVI) Skilled Worker Licence sponsor and are unable to sponsor any individuals for Skilled Worker Sponsorship. Candidates must ensure they have the appropriate rights to work in the UK before application.

Security Clearance

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check](#). To allow for meaningful checks to be carried out, candidates will be required to have at least 5 years continuous residency in the UK. All applicants for this role must ensure that they meet this minimum residency requirement - if you do not, your application will be withdrawn.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Delivering at Pace

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Programming & Build (Software Engineering) (Skill level: Practitioner).

Modern Development Standards (Skill level: Practitioner).

Systems Integration (Skill level: Working).

Systems Design (Skill level: Working).

Benefits

Passionate, reliable and always willing to push yourself and those around you, you'll continue to seek improvement in your own role and challenge us too. Because we pride ourselves on how we approach your development. From training courses to specialist skills workshops and opportunities to grow your expertise, we thrive when you thrive. You can find out more about all of the above [here](#) alongside a full list of our benefits:

Best in class learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity with a range of staff communities to support all our colleagues

Generous employer contribution of 28.9%, depending on chosen pension scheme

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Digital communities with clear career frameworks

On-site gym plus personal training available (membership applies)

On-site nursery, restaurants and coffee bar

25 days holiday (plus bank holidays), increasing by 1 each year (up to 30) & 8 Bank Holidays plus an additional Privilege Day to mark the King's birthday.

24-hour Employee Assistance Programme providing free confidential help and advice for staff.

Free parking

Find out more about [the benefits of working at DfT and its agencies](#) (opens in a new window).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Our selection process ensures a comprehensive assessment of each applicant's qualifications, skills, and potential fit within our organisation.

The selection process for this role will be:

Stage 1: Sift of CV and Personal Statement by Inspire People (our recruitment Partners)

Stage 2: Sift of CV by DVLA panel

Stage 3: Interview with Whiteboard Exercise & Coding Assessment

You must be successful at each stage to progress to the next stage.

Stage 1: Sift by Inspire People

As part of the application process, you will be asked to provide a CV (unlimited wordcount) and personal statement (up to 750-word count) to Inspire People (our Recruitment Partners) which outlines your experience and suitability for the role (based on the experience points outlined in the essential criteria on this advert).

To apply please click 'Apply at advertiser's site' at the bottom of the page.

At sift, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Experience - Within your CV & Personal statement please provide evidence of your Experience of the following essential criteria:

Describe your experience working on one or more commercial, software delivery projects, highlighting a project or solution you enjoyed the most, and what does that tell us about the kind of work you're most passionate about?

Describe your experience in one or more technical specialism such as Java, C#, front-end development or serverless, highlighting any technologies or skills you'd like to learn more about

Stage 2: Sift by DVLA panel

If successful through sift by Inspire People your CV and personal statement will then be sifted by a panel at DVLA

This sift will take place from 30th July 2026.

Stage 3: Interview with Whiteboard Exercise & Coding Assessment

At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Behaviours Delivering at Pace

Technical

[Software Developer: Programming & Build \(Software Engineering\) \(Skill level: Practitioner\)](#).

Modern Development Standards [Software Developer: Modern Development Standards \(Skill level: Practitioner\)](#).

Systems Integration [Software Developer: Systems Integration \(Skill level: Working\)](#).

System Design [Software Developer: Systems Design \(Skill level: Working\)](#).

The interview will also include a Whiteboard Exercise and a Coding Assessment. Guidance will be provided if you are invited to interview.

The interviews will take place week commencing 10th August 2026.

This interview will be conducted online via Microsoft Teams. Further details will be provided to you should you be selected for interview.

You can find out more about [our hiring process, how to apply, and application and interview guidance on our careers site \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Please note that we will try to meet the dates set out in the advert. There may be occasions when these dates will change.

Further information on the selection process

We will also hold a 12-month reserve list for this role, which may lead to potential opportunities beyond the role you applied for. You can read more about our reserve lists [here](#).

If your application is successful but you have been dismissed from the Civil Service, your application could be removed at the pre-employment checking stage depending on the nature of the dismissal.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be

refused employment. A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

All external applicants and current employees of accredited non-departmental public bodies (NDPBs) will be required to undergo a Social Media Check. A Social Media Check is a review of your publicly available online activity, typically across platforms like LinkedIn, Facebook, X (formerly Twitter), Instagram, and others. The purpose is to identify any public posts or content that could raise concerns for employers, such as:

- Hate speech or discriminatory behaviour

- Threats or acts of violence

- Illegal activity or substance misuse

- Sexually explicit material

- Extremist views or affiliations

Importantly, this check does not involve hacking into your accounts or accessing private messages. It only considers content you have chosen to make public. Employers use this kind of screening to help ensure their workplace remains safe, inclusive, and aligned with company values. It's not about judging your personality or lifestyle - it's about checking for potential red flags that might affect the role or company culture. If you have questions or concerns about the social media check, we would be happy to explain in more detail what's being looked at and how your data is handled securely and fairly.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Zymante "Zee" Gintalaite

Email : zymante@inspirepeople.net

Recruitment team

Email : dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact Government Recruitment Services via email: dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Click here (<https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/>) to visit Civil Service Commission

Civil Service
Commission

